PUNJAB: A RADICAL MANN
PG 11

J&K: A STICKY FORM OF TERROR
PG 20

UPFRONT

PREZ POLLS: THE ULTIMATE BATTLE
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BANGALORED? TAKE A TRAIN
PG 22



IN THE NET Gaus Mohammed (L) and Riyaz Akhtari after their arrest

ANI

RAJASTHAN

TERROR AND TENSION

By Rohit Parihar

It took just a few minutes for the video of the brutal murder of a 40-year-old tailor in Udaipur to go viral on the internet. In the video they shot at his shop and uploaded, the assailants—Riyaz Akhtari and Gaus Mohammed—also displayed the blood-soaked cleavers they had used to hack the tailor, Kanhaiya Lal, to death and said they were "avenging an insult to Islam". They had told the tailor that they wanted to get a dress stitched, and when Kanhaiya Lal was taking measurements, one of them started recording the scene on camera. The chilling moments followed soon after. Apparently, they even tried to behead the victim but failed. The slain tailor's body had 26 injuries.

The sequence of events leading up to Kanhaiya Lal's murder began apparently with the victim posting on social media a photograph of Nupur Sharma, the suspended BJP spokesperson who had allegedly made blasphemous comments about Prophet Mohammed. On June 11, some persons—said to be policemen in plainclothes—had come to Kanhaiya Lal's shop and deleted Sharma's photo from the social media site, saying it was objectionable. Kanhaiya Lal apparently told them that he used the phone only to make and receive calls, and that it was his eight-year-old son who had been posting on social media. That very evening, acting